

NovaCart

Refund Policy

Document Type: Customer & Support Knowledge Base Policy

Version: 1.0

Status: Active for Autonomous Customer Support Copilot Demo

Policy Area	Refund eligibility, processing and customer support
Applies To	NovaCart customers with eligible payment or order issues
Supported Region	India
Support Email	support@novacart.example
Support Hours	Monday–Sunday, 9:00 AM–9:00 PM IST

1. Purpose

This Refund Policy explains when a NovaCart customer may be eligible for a refund, how refund requests are reviewed, how approved refunds are processed, and how customers should contact support when a refund is delayed or disputed.

The policy is intended to provide consistent guidance to customers and the Autonomous Customer Support Copilot. Refund decisions may depend on the order status, payment status, product conditions, cancellation or return eligibility, and the information available in NovaCart systems.

2. When a Refund May Be Considered

A refund may be considered in situations such as:

- Payment was successfully deducted but a valid order was not created or confirmed.
- An eligible order was cancelled before fulfillment.
- An eligible returned product was received and approved for refund.
- NovaCart was unable to fulfill an order after payment was captured.
- A confirmed duplicate payment was identified.
- A support or operations process authorizes a refund under an applicable policy.

Refund eligibility is not automatic merely because a customer requests a refund. The order and payment information must be reviewed according to the applicable policy.

3. Refund Eligibility

Eligibility depends on the reason for the refund and the condition or status of the order.

For an order-related refund, support may verify:

- Order number and order status.
- Whether the item was delivered, cancelled, returned, or undeliverable.
- Whether the product is eligible under the applicable return policy.

- Whether the payment was successfully captured.
- Whether a refund has already been initiated.

If the available information does not establish eligibility, the case may require human review.

4. Payment Deducted but Order Not Confirmed

If a customer's payment was deducted but NovaCart did not confirm the order, the case should first be checked against the payment and order records.

The customer should provide the transaction/reference ID, payment amount, approximate transaction time, and available receipt or confirmation.

If the payment is confirmed as captured but no valid order can be fulfilled or confirmed, the case may be eligible for a refund. The customer should not be promised an immediate refund before payment verification is completed.

5. Failed Payment With a Deduction

If the checkout shows a failed payment but the customer's bank or payment provider shows a deduction, the transaction may still be pending, reversed, or successfully captured.

Support should verify the transaction status before deciding the next action. If the amount is later reversed automatically, a separate refund may not be required. If the amount is confirmed as captured without a corresponding order, the case can be handled under the payment-deduction-without-order process.

6. Duplicate Payments

If a customer reports being charged twice, NovaCart should verify each transaction independently.

Possible outcomes include:

- One payment succeeded and another transaction is pending.
- One transaction was reversed or released by the payment provider.
- Both transactions were successfully captured.

A refund may be initiated for a confirmed duplicate successful payment after verification. Customers should provide the relevant transaction references whenever possible.

7. Return-Related Refunds

When a refund is requested because a product is returned, the return must first satisfy the applicable Return Policy requirements.

Depending on the product and reason for return, the product may need to be received and inspected before a refund is approved. A refund should not be represented as approved until the required return review has been completed.

Product-specific return exclusions and conditions are maintained in the Return Policy.

8. Cancellation-Related Refunds

If an eligible prepaid order is cancelled, the payment may be refunded after the cancellation is successfully recorded and the payment status is verified.

Orders that have already entered shipment or another fulfillment stage may have different cancellation and refund conditions. Customers should refer to the Cancellation Policy and order status for the applicable process.

9. Refund Methods

Where possible, an approved refund is returned through the original payment method or the payment channel associated with the transaction.

The exact refund route may depend on the payment method, transaction status, and payment provider. Cash-equivalent or alternative refund arrangements should not be promised unless an authorized NovaCart process supports them.

10. Refund Processing Stages

A refund-related case may move through the following stages:

1. Customer reports the issue.
2. Support identifies the order and payment.
3. Eligibility and transaction status are verified.
4. Refund is approved when applicable.
5. Refund is initiated through the appropriate process.
6. Payment provider processes the transaction.
7. Refund status is communicated or updated.
8. Case is closed after successful resolution or appropriate escalation.

The time taken after initiation may depend on the payment provider and banking system.

11. Refund Timeline Guidance

Refund processing does not necessarily mean that the amount will appear immediately in the customer's account.

Customers should distinguish between:

- Refund approved — NovaCart has determined that the case qualifies.
- Refund initiated — the refund process has been submitted.
- Refund completed — the payment provider has completed the return of funds.

If a refund has been initiated but the customer does not see the amount after the expected processing period, the customer should contact support with the refund or transaction reference.

12. Refund Exceptions

A refund may be declined, delayed, or require additional investigation when:

- The order or payment cannot be verified.
- The customer has already received a refund for the same transaction.
- The requested refund does not meet the applicable return or cancellation conditions.
- The payment was never successfully captured.
- The transaction is still pending with the payment provider.
- The case involves suspected fraud or unauthorized activity.
- Required information is missing.

The AI assistant must not invent an exception or make a final refund decision when the policy does not provide enough information.

13. Unauthorized or Suspicious Transactions

If a customer reports a payment they do not recognize, support should treat the case as a security-sensitive issue.

Customers should contact their bank or payment provider promptly and should not share passwords, OTPs, card PINs, UPI PINs, or other authentication credentials with NovaCart support.

The support case may be escalated for account and transaction review. The AI assistant should avoid claiming that an unauthorized transaction has been refunded unless an authorized system confirms the action.

14. Information Required for Refund Support

Support may request non-sensitive information such as:

- Order number.
- Transaction/reference ID.
- Payment amount.
- Payment date and approximate time.
- Payment method.
- Reason for the refund request.
- Return information, when relevant.
- Refund reference, if a refund was already initiated.

Customers should never provide passwords, PINs, OTPs, or full confidential payment credentials.

15. Refund Ticket and Escalation

A simple question such as “How long does a refund normally take?” can generally be answered using the approved knowledge base.

A ticket or escalation may be required when:

- A payment was deducted but no order was created.
- A duplicate successful payment must be investigated.
- A refund was approved but remains unresolved.
- A return inspection is disputed.
- The transaction status cannot be verified automatically.
- The customer disputes the refund decision.
- The issue requires access to internal payment or order records.

The Copilot should create or escalate a ticket when human investigation is required.

16. Customer Communication Rules

Support responses should clearly distinguish between eligibility, approval, initiation, and completion.

Preferred guidance:

- Do not say “your refund is completed” unless completion is verified.
- Do not promise a specific refund date unless supported by the applicable policy or transaction status.
- Explain what information the customer needs to provide.

- Give the customer a clear next step.
- Escalate unresolved transaction-specific issues rather than guessing.

17. Examples

Example 1 — Refund status:

Customer: "My refund was approved. When will I receive it?"

Expected handling: Explain that approval and receipt are different stages and that the timing can depend on the payment provider.

Example 2 — Payment deducted, no order:

Customer: "My money was deducted but I did not get an order."

Expected handling: Ask for transaction details, verify the payment/order status, and escalate when transaction investigation is required.

Example 3 — Duplicate charge:

Customer: "I paid twice for one order."

Expected handling: Request the relevant transaction references and verify whether both payments were captured before initiating a refund.

Example 4 — General refund question:

Customer: "Can I get a refund for an eligible cancelled order?"

Expected handling: Explain the applicable cancellation/refund process without claiming that a refund has already been approved.

18. Relationship With Other Policies

This Refund Policy works together with NovaCart's Payment Policy, Return Policy, Cancellation Policy, and Customer Support Policy.

The Payment Policy explains payment verification and payment failures. The Return Policy determines return eligibility. The Cancellation Policy determines cancellation conditions. This document governs the refund handling process after eligibility is established.

19. Policy Authority

This document is the authoritative refund-policy source for the NovaCart customer-support knowledge base. The Autonomous Customer Support Copilot should retrieve and use this policy when answering refund-related questions.

If the available documentation does not provide enough information to determine a customer's specific refund outcome, the AI assistant should request appropriate non-sensitive information and escalate the issue rather than inventing a decision.

This document is fictional and created exclusively for the Autonomous Customer Support Copilot project.